

The following code illustrates caching of plain text passphrases:

```
$ svn co https://localhost/svn/repos wc
Authentication realm: https://localhost:443
Client certificate filename: /home/styleesen/styleesen.p12
Passphrase for '/home/styleesen/styleesen.p12':
```

ATTENTION! Your passphrase for client certificate:

```
/home/styleesen/styleesen.p12
```

can only be stored to disk unencrypted! You are advised to configure your system so that Subversion can store passphrase encrypted, if possible. See the documentation for details.

You can avoid future appearances of this warning by setting the value of the 'store-sal-client-cert-pk-plaintext' option to either 'yes' or 'no' in '/home/styleesen/subversion/servers'.

```
Store passphrase unencrypted (yes/no)? yes
Checked out revision 0.
```

Encrypted password/passphrase caching

Version 1.6 provides an easy way in which passwords/passphrases can be cached in an encrypted form in *NIX systems. If you are a GNOME user and want to store Subversion passwords in encrypted form, then you can use the GNOME Keyring to do so. KDE users can make use of KWallet. In order to use either of these, the Subversion binaries must be compiled with the option for GNOME Keyring or KWallet support. The password stores that must be used can be configured by specifying it in Subversion config at `~/.subversion/config`.

```
[auth]
### Set password stores used by Subversion. They should be
### delimited by spaces or commas. The order of values determines
### the order in which password stores are used.
### Valid password stores:
###  gnome-keyring      (Unix-like systems)
###  kwallet            (Unix-like systems)
###  keychain           (Mac OS X)
###  windows-cryptoapi (Windows)
password-stores = gnome-keyring , kwallet
```

In order to enable Subversion to cache passwords in GNOME Keyring we need to pass the following parameter to the `configure` script while compiling Subversion source:

```
--with-gnome-keyring
```

The above requires GNOME Keyring libraries available in your operating system, failing which Subversion falls back to caching passwords unencrypted. Once you have Subversion binary code

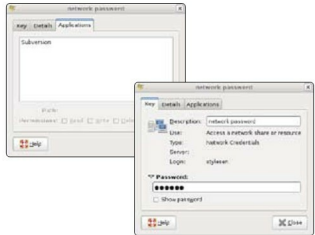


Figure 1: Subversion using GNOME Keyring to store passwords in encrypted form

compiled with GNOME Keyring support, the passwords are automatically cached in Keyring, provided it is unlocked. Figure 1 illustrates a Subversion password stored in GNOME Keyring.

If the GNOME Keyring is locked, you'll get a prompt to unlock it. Once unlocked, the password will get stored in Keyring. A sample run is as follows:

```
$ svn co http://localhost/svn/repos wc
Password for 'default' GNOME keyring:
Authentication realm: <http://localhost:80> TEST SVN repository
Password for 'styleesen':
Checked out revision 0.
```

```
$ svn co http://localhost/svn/repos wc
Checked out revision 0.
$
```

KDE can also make use of KWallet in order to store passwords in encrypted form. In order to use KWallet, the Subversion binaries must be compiled with the following option:

```
--with-kwallet
```

Subversion is a widely used version control system in many free software projects and corporate environments. With its new features and improvements, users will benefit from the ease with which they can use it. The latest release (version 1.6.1) of the source can be downloaded from subversion.tigris.org. If you want Subversion binaries for different platforms, visit open.collab.net. 

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